Experiment 11

Designing Pages and Navigation for a Multi-Page Business Application in Zoho Creator

Aim

To design pages and a navigation menu for the "Leave Management" application in Zoho Creator so that users can move easily between its different screens.

Objectives

- To understand the use of pages in Zoho Creator.
- To create a Home page and a Help page for the application.
- To arrange forms, reports and pages in the navigation menu.
- To test the navigation in the live application.

Requirements

Item	Details
Software	Zoho Creator account
Application	"Leave Management" application created in Experiment 10
Browser	Chrome, Edge or Firefox

Introduction

A business application usually has more than one screen. Users should be able to find the form, the reports and the help information without confusion. In Zoho Creator, a **page** is a custom screen that can contain text, images, buttons, links, embedded forms and reports. The **navigation menu** is the list of links, shown on the left or top of the application, through which a user opens these components. A well planned menu saves time and reduces training effort.

Components Used for Navigation

Component	Use
Page	Welcome screen, instructions or dashboard
Section	Group in the menu that holds related links, for example "Employee" or "Manager"
Button	Opens a form or a report or another page
Embedded form / report	Shows the form or the report inside the page
Menu order	Decides the sequence in which the items are shown

Plan of the Application Pages

Page / Component	Type	Content	Menu Section
Home	Page	Welcome text, buttons for Apply Leave and My Leaves	Main
Leave Request	Form	Form to apply for leave	Employee
My Leave Records	Report	List of leave requests	Employee
Pending Requests	Report	Requests waiting for approval	Manager
Help	Page	Steps to apply for leave and contact details of HR	Main

Procedure

Part A: Creating Pages

1. Open the "Leave Management" application in edit mode.
2. Click on "Add new component" and select "Page".
3. Give the name "Home" and click "Create".
4. In the page builder, drag a text element and type the heading "Welcome to Leave Management".
5. Add two buttons, "Apply Leave" and "View My Leaves", and link them to the Leave Request form and the report.
6. Save the page and repeat the steps to create the "Help" page with usage instructions.

Part B: Arranging the Navigation

1. Open the menu or navigation settings of the application.
2. Create sections named "Employee" and "Manager".
3. Drag the Leave Request form and My Leave Records report into the Employee section.
4. Place the Pending Requests report in the Manager section.
5. Move the Home page to the top and set it as the first page that opens.
6. Save the changes.

Part C: Testing

1. Click "Access Application" to open the live view.
2. Click on each link in the menu and check that the correct screen opens.
3. Click the buttons on the Home page and confirm that they open the form and report.
4. Open the application on a mobile browser to check that the layout is readable.

Observations

Item Tested	Expected Result	Result
Home menu link	Home page opens first	As expected
Apply Leave button	Leave Request form opens	As expected
View My Leaves button	Report opens	As expected
Pending Requests link	Report opens with pending records	As expected
Help link	Help page opens	As expected

Design Guidelines Followed

- Keep the menu short and use clear names such as "Apply Leave" instead of technical names.
- Group related items under one section.
- Place the most used items at the top of the menu.
- Use the same colours, fonts and button styles on all pages.
- Give a way to go back to the Home page from every screen.

Result

Home and Help pages were created and the menu of the application was arranged in sections. All links and buttons opened the correct components in the live application.

Conclusion

Pages and navigation make an application easy to use. By grouping the links according to the type of user and keeping the important actions on the home page, a multi-page application can be used with very little training.